SOURCE-LED RESEARCH // 16 OCTOBER 2026

Premium UX / UI Research Brain

Creator-specific, timestamped analysis and independently qualified implementation guidance for AI product-building agents.

RESEARCH EDITION 01

Includes 3 caption-grounded UX Peak papers, 1 description-only study note, anti-AI-slop review, agent rules and complete requested-source ledger.

Important: partial coverage, not full-channel analysis. Four direct-link videos and all direct source-frame captures remain pending.

Coverage summary

Item	Count / status
Requested video links	5 registered; 1 accessible caption-derived transcript
Requested channels	2; complete video inventories not available
Additional UX Peak videos discovered	3 (2 with captions, 1 video description only)
True video screenshots	0 — planned timestamps recorded, not captured
Evidence tags	T = transcript, V = frame, S = support, I = interpretation

The companion ZIP is the canonical machine-readable bundle; the PDF is a reading copy. Source links and exact coverage status are listed in `source-ledger/SOURCE_MANIFEST.csv`. No unverifiable screenshot or transcript has been invented.

Premium UI/UX Research Brain — Evidence-First Edition

Build date: 2026-10-16
Stage: PARTIAL — verified transcript papers plus explicitly pending sources. **Not a finished full-channel review.**
Scope requested: @TimGabe, @uxpeak/videos (every available video eventually), and five direct links.
Method: T = transcript-derived; V = direct video frame; S = external/creator supporting source; I = independent interpretation. Distinct source categories are never merged.

Start here

1. `source-ledger/SOURCE_MANIFEST.csv`: Every requested URL (including the direct links not yet retrievable), plus extra discovered UX Peak videos.
2. `papers/uxpeak-2TlIg3VokY8.md`: a detailed source- and timestamp-grounded research paper on *The UX Psychology Behind Apps People Can't Stop Using* (T).
3. `papers/uxpeak-zr37ibqXl1U.md`: detailed independent research paper on three UX redesign comparisons (T); discovered during the channel audit, **not one of the five direct links**.
4. `papers/uxpeak-03Xw8UyC6uo.md`: foundations paper (T); discovered during the channel audit.
5. `papers/uxpeak-GGg61sdEjeI.md`: shorter paper using YouTube video description metadata (S), **not the transcript**.
6. `papers/ai-slop-independent.md`: independent synthesis relevant to the user-highlighted video XKDfs9xTzfw, whose content is **not yet accessed** (S/I only).
7. `AGENT_RULES.md`: design + implementation instructions, explicitly distinguishing research findings from our recommendations.
8. `methodology/CAPTURE_AND_QA.md`: ingestion, video-frame capture and transcript QA; visual evidence pending.
9. `source-ledger/EVIDENCE_INDEX.csv`: time-stamped claims and source states.

What was actually verified

- UX Peak **2TlIg3VokY8**: English caption-derived timestamped transcript via https://youtube2text.diguardia.org/v/the-ux-psychology-behind-apps-people-can-t-stop-using-2TlIg3VokY8. Counts reported by this transcription site: 2,115 words and 333 segments. Descriptions also available from YouTube search indexing.
- UX Peak **zr37ibqXl1U**: timestamped caption-derived transcript via https://youtube2text.diguardia.org/v/top-3-ux-ui-redesigns-that-make-you-design-like-a-pro-zr37ibqXl1U. Site reports 2,480 words and 383 segments.
- UX Peak **03Xw8UyC6uo**: timestamped caption-derived transcript via https://youtube2text.diguardia.org/v/the-shortest-ux-ui-design-course-03Xw8UyC6uo. Site reports 1,166 words and 183 segments.
- UX Peak **GGg61sdEjeI**: published description on a third-party video mirror, not full transcript.
- UX Peak’s own website provides independent public before/after descriptions; Tim Gabe’s own website identifies his Framer, Figma and creative work. These are supporting sources (S), not evidence of what either said in an inaccessible video.

Not verified; do not present as completed video research

The direct videos **8EAYZe6y3I8**, **qJ4qYhTqAz0**, **soZgjJi7xNw** and **XKDfs9xTzfw** could not be resolved to reliable transcripts in this research session. They remain registered in the manifest. None has been silently dropped or substituted with a similarly themed video. The full inventories of @uxpeak and @TimGabe could not be reliably enumerated because their YouTube channel pages returned minimal content; claiming every upload has been studied would be false. No actual video frames were captured, and no supplied source screenshots are included as if they were frames. See capture plan.

Evidence principles

- **T:** Quote no more than short excerpts and provide timestamp + transcript URL. Primary video remains the canonical linked source; a third-party caption export is a transcript surrogate, and ASR/caption errors are possible.
- **V:** Only true frame extraction from accessible video at an exact timestamp. A video thumbnail, illustration, recreation or website screenshot is not a verified frame.
- **S:** Clearly label creator web pages, design articles, official docs, video descriptions and supporting research. Never turn a creator's marketing description into a proven causal finding.
- **I:** Our own normative recommendations are hypotheses or practical standards, not video quotations, replicated experimental results, or observed real-world performance.
- Creator-showcased A/B designs do **not** automatically indicate a real published, randomized A/B experiment. Without methodology or measurements, treat creator performance comparisons as creator-asserted demonstrations.
- Psychological numerical claims (for example 70–90% default adherence, '2x' loss aversion, large conversion lifts) must not be encoded as universal facts unless independently verified.

Accessibility for coding agents

Check this README; read `AGENT_RULES.md`; retrieve the paper that corresponds to the screen/flow being built; link any design rationale to evidence IDs in `EVIDENCE_INDEX.csv`. Do not load all papers into the model's context unnecessarily. For shared use across Claude, Codex and other agents, commit this directory to the repo or expose it via an authorized file-retrieval system and point each agent's instructions to it. The files do not become cross-model memory automatically.

Important copyright note

The package contains detailed, original, timecoded analyses and only very short quotations rather than reproducing entire third-party video transcripts. The transcript links let a reviewer consult the full original caption-derived sources where available.

Research Paper R04 — The UX Psychology Behind Apps People Can’t Stop Using

Creator: uxpeak | **Published:** 2 July 2026 (indexed video metadata) | **Video:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2TlIg3VokY8 | **Transcript surrogate:** https://youtube2text.diguardia.org/v/the-ux-psychology-behind-apps-people-can-t-stop-using-2TlIg3VokY8

Evidence status: T VERIFIED (caption-derived text, 333 timecoded segments); V NOT REVIEWED. The wording below is analytical paraphrase, not an original transcript export. The creator’s own claims are not independently validated experiments. **Scope:** Every substantive instructional segment in the retrieved captions, including sales/sponsor interruptions and potential drawbacks.

Abstract [I]

The video argues that behavioral framing can make otherwise identical interfaces feel easier to begin, complete, and trust. The six core comparisons address smart defaults, perceived progress, value-before-signup, personalization/ownership, loss framing and price contrast. The valuable underlying insight is to make the next decision concrete and manageable. The major limitation: several claims are stated as universal effects without independently checked evidence, and some proposed persuasion techniques risk creating dark patterns. The strongest implementation candidates for premium consumer apps are defensible defaults, honest progress, genuine product value before registration, and price/term transparency.

1. Smart defaults — 00:22–01:44 [T001]

What the creator says/illustrates in the captions: A booking form initially presents five empty fields, making the user decide each value. The alternative prefills typical inputs and changes a generic search CTA to a result-aware button indicating 12 available outcomes. The creator argues that scanning and correcting

suggestions is easier than generating every entry from scratch. The video cites an assortment experiment involving 24 versus six jam varieties, plus a statistic about default adherence; these figures appear as claims in the transcript, **not independently verified here**.

Screen comparison [T, not V]: A = five empty inputs and undifferentiated ‘search’; B = the same inputs with common values selected plus a concrete result count. We do not know exact spacing, colors or font properties without video access.

Analysis [I]: Defaults work if the system has a strong basis: returning user’s saved preference, current context with reliable confidence, or commonly selected safe options. They can harm trust if they silently set expensive, privacy-relevant, irreversible or legally meaningful options. Result counts must be computed, not invented. Defaults must be easily editable, visible and reversible.

For MockMob [I]: Prefill a practice experience with the student’s current eligible subject and sensible question count *only if* backed by previous behavior or an explicitly described default. Make the CTA specific: ‘Start 10 Accountancy questions’. Do not fabricate number of available questions. **Test:** time-to-first-question, % defaults edited, incorrect-start reversals, practice completion.

For Circuit [I]: Preselect previously used campus and last-seen filter when clearly labeled; avoid automatically opting people into public sharing or notifications.

2. Perceived progress / goal gradient — 01:45–03:12 [T002]

Creator presentation [T]: A loyalty card requiring eight purchases is contrasted with a card listing ten stamps where two are initially included, so both demand eight additional purchases. The associated onboarding mockup contrasts an initial 0% indicator with 20% progress credited for an account-creation step. LinkedIn profile-strength UI is mentioned. The claim that completion nearly doubled in a study is creator-attributed and **not rechecked against primary evidence**.

Analysis [I]: People need an intelligible map of remaining effort. Frontloading credit is only acceptable if the credit corresponds to actually completed work, such as identifying a goal or joining the service. Fictitious advancement can make later progress look inconsistent and undermine trust. Prefer a labeled step sequence to an arbitrary percent when duration varies.

MockMob implementation: E.g., ‘Step 1 of 3: Pick your exam’ only after the user actually picks it; reward finishing the first assessment with a real baseline report. Never show 20% without a verifiable state. **Tests:** step completion and post-onboarding confidence, not just activation.

Sponsor/source-context interruption — 03:13–03:48 [T]

The captions shift to a sponsorship pitch for a UI screenshot-library product. The creator states they search real app onboarding flows when designing. This is **commercially disclosed promotional context**, not independent proof that any specific pattern is optimal. A library is useful for descriptive evidence of what products ship, but screenshots alone are not causal performance validation.

3. Give value before signup — 03:49–05:37 [T003]

Creator comparison [T]: An analysis-tool user submits a URL, waits for a scan, and encounters blurred results requiring registration. The alternative exposes a genuinely useful initial report (score, top issues, successful checks) and asks users to sign up to save or access a more complete breakdown. The creator relates this to reciprocity and mentions Costco, Spotify and Notion. The dramatic percentage claim about purchase lift is *unverified creator narration*.

Design reasoning [I]: A preview is evidence of utility, not merely bait. It should answer at least one meaningful user question and permit a concrete next action. Avoid suggesting a scan ran if no analysis was done. No artificial blurring of already-calculated user data solely to cause frustration. A user should understand what registration adds: persistence, history, recommendations or sync.

MockMob [I]: Let a first-time user answer a short sample and see an actual score/solution insight without immediately requiring full registration; invite registration to save progress, build history and access a personalized recovery plan. Beware abuse/rate limits and ensure guest state can be migrated. **Metrics:** sample start, sample completion, meaningful activation, registration after value, week-1 retention.

Circuit [I]: Preview verified public student communities or public campus events before requesting account creation, while restricting sensitive student content and gated verification functions.

4. IKEA/endowment effects — 05:38–07:02 [T004]

Creator comparison [T]: Generic sign-up form versus pre-signup customization of a profile/name/title/color/card style, with the action relabeled around continuing existing work. Duolingo’s goal-selection and lesson-before-account flow is cited as an illustration. These are narrated examples; current third-party app behavior wasn’t inspected.

Analysis [I]: Give users authorship over something useful: a tailored learning goal, personal learning path or recognizable profile. Ensure work is preserved through auth and that users can abandon without guilt. ‘Invested time’ should not be exploited to withhold a user’s own data behind an unexpected charge.

MockMob: Let a student set an exam target, subject priority and test intent, then show a relevant sample path. Persist their choices in guest state. Measure whether personalization actually improves relevance versus adding needless onboarding friction.

Commercial interruption — 07:03–08:18 [T]

This segment markets the creator’s learning product and includes industry/professional claims. Log as commercial context, not UX evidence.

5. Loss framing — 08:19–09:35 [T005]

Creator comparison [T]: Plain cloud-storage premium upsell listing features versus a screen showing particular files at risk, a countdown, and an uncomfortable opt-out. The creator contends that loss aversion and status quo bias can increase motivation.

Critical evaluation [I, HIGH-RISK]: The example mixes a legitimate possible warning (an actual scheduled deletion) with potentially coercive presentation. A fear-based CTA can spike short-term conversion while eroding consent, trust and retention. If deletion is real, disclose exact affected files, rule, date, recovery options and a respectful alternative; if it is not real, the prompt is deceptive. **Agent rule: DO NOT implement emotionally coercive ‘I’ll risk it’ language, fabricated timers or invented loss.** Compare opt-in comprehension and customer complaints, not only clicks.

MockMob: Do not threaten lost ranks or disappearing marks to pressure students into payment. Present the actual benefit of retaining history and the truthful expiration, if any, of guest sessions.

6. Contrast effect in pricing — 09:36–11:30 [T006]

Creator comparison [T]: A $50/month protection plan alone versus immediately after a $1,900 laptop, where $50 is labeled about 2.6% of the laptop price. Restaurant price ladders and sequential real-estate comparisons are offered as examples. These are the creator’s illustrations, not independently observed transactions.

Critical evaluation [I]: The comparison is *not apples-to-apples*: a recurring $50 monthly charge versus a one-time $1,900 price. Presenting ‘2.6%’ without its time-base may mislead. At 12 payments it is $600/year. A transparent price screen should show duration, renewal, total commitment, cancellation and applicable taxes; use meaningful reference prices only where real and comparable. Pricing hierarchy should improve comprehension rather than suppress it.

MockMob: Show actual ₹/month, renewal mechanics, included usage limits, any credit expiration and total payable. Avoid false crossed-out prices, artificial countdowns or long-term claims when the offer is monthly.

Claims requiring separate scientific review [I]

- Jam purchase rates and attribution: mentioned in narration, not audited against primary paper.
- Loyalty-card result and study attribution: mentioned in narration, not audited against original research.
- ‘70–90%’ never changing defaults: no support established in this package; **not** a reusable product statistic.
- Large effects for free samples: creator assertion, not proof of universal conversion effect.
- ‘Loss feels exactly twice as strong’: psychological effect is contextual; never encode as an invariant multiplier.
- A/B screenshots and ‘improves retention’ narration: no experiment protocol, sample, confidence interval, or raw measurements provided.

Source hierarchy / provenance

- **T:** Caption-derived timecodes and verbal examples from the transcript link above.
- **V:** None. The video may show designs that are more detailed than the spoken description; no frames were verified.
- **S:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2TIlg3VokY8 (indexed description); https://www.uxpeak.com/pages/about ; https://baymard.com/blog/checkout-flow-ux-optimization (smart checkout defaults, true progress); https://www.nngroup.com/articles/progressive-disclosure/ (managing complexity).
- **I:** All agent rules, ethical caveats, test plans, and product-specific examples here.

Bottom line [I]

The strongest generalizable insight is not ‘manipulate users through psychology.’ It is **reduce ambiguity, deliver tangible value before asking for commitment, show real progress and**

make cost/next steps legible. Adopt those moves with measurement and guardrails. Treat conversion-optimized fear framing and misleading reference prices as anti-patterns.

Research Paper D01 — Top 3 UX/UI Redesigns That Make You Design Like a Pro

Creator: uxpeak | **Video:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zr37ibqXl1U | **Transcript:** https://youtube2text.diguardia.org/v/top-3-ux-ui-redesigns-that-make-you-design-like-a-pro-zr37ibqXl1U | **Caption status:** 383 time-stamped segments / 2,480 words reported | **Direct visual review:** NOT COMPLETED. **Provenance:** discovered during channel research, not directly linked by user.

Abstract [I]

Three before/after comparisons address a subscription trial, a ride selection flow and a villa booking screen. Their common denominator is *decision quality*: clarify a commitment, reduce unpredictable prices, and answer practical and emotional objections. The creator repeatedly says one mockup ‘performs dramatically better,’ but neither a controlled experiment nor a real launch metric is established in the transcript. They should be treated as narrated comparative design cases, not independently verified A/B test outcomes.

Case 1: A trial that explains rather than pressures, 00:36–05:19 [T007]

Source-side A [T]: A $19/month gaming subscription pitch with decorative space hero art, generic benefit bullets, and a CTA that combines subscribing with a seven-day trial.

Source-side B [T]: A trial explanation with a clear three-step schedule: day of activation, reminder on day five, and first billing on day seven. The CTA focuses on starting a trial; supportive detail claims a concrete two-tap start. The proposed preview uses actual game characters instead of a generic image.

Creator reasoning [T]: Reduce perceived commitment and uncertainty; show concrete steps, user benefits, a candid reminder, specific effort estimate and identifiable product content.

Independent critique [I]: The timeline must reflect actual billing/ notification logic. A ‘reminder sent’ assertion is forbidden without a functioning event-delivery system and appropriate permission. ‘Start my free trial’ cannot hide the fact that a subscription renews; price and auto-renewal must remain visible. The two-tap promise must be true for the user’s actual journey, including authentication and payment. Real product preview is stronger evidence of what is sold than irrelevant artwork.

MockMob application [I]: If offering a free trial, expose a real sequence of feature access, trial deadline and subsequent billing. The plan should say exactly what students receive and what happens at the end. Show actual test modes and examples rather than abstract ‘unlock unlimited potential’ copy. A/B-test comprehension and cancellation satisfaction alongside conversion.

Case 2: Quoted fares vs uncertainty, 06:55–09:37 [T008]

Source-side A [T]: Three ride types with fare *ranges* (narrated examples include $13–17 and $17–22), leaving users to estimate final cost.

Source-side B [T]: A single presented price per ride, estimated arrival such as ‘2 minutes away’, a destination card on the map, and a conspicuous cheaper label.

Creator reasoning [T]: People can compare definite values more easily than several uncertain ranges, and arrival information changes the perceived decision from pure expense to convenience. The creator explicitly contrasts labels such as cheaper and the anchoring effect of the highest possible fare.

Independent critique [I]: A definite *quote* is beneficial if the product can honor it. Presenting an uncertain estimate as a guaranteed price is deceptive. If supply, surge pricing, taxes or fees vary, represent a realistic range with a plain-language rationale and

a final confirmation step. The ‘cheaper’ badge needs a clear comparison baseline. This case does not justify hiding meaningful uncertainty.

Circuit application [I]: In event listings, distinguish fixed costs from ‘from ₹x’, approved times from tentative timings and guaranteed seats from waitlists. Where an offer is definite, prefer one clear value; where uncertain, say so.

Case 3: From booking form to specific experience, 10:37–13:57 [T009]

Source-side A [T]: Small villa thumbnail, factual headline, 4.82 rating, €89/night, dates and ‘reserve’.

Source-side B [T]: Much larger property photography; trust badges (for example guest favorite), photo count, specific emotionally engaging description, price comparison (€129 crossed out against €89), explicit weekday/date/night count, CTA incorporating €445 total and a free-cancellation detail.

Creator reasoning [T]: Show what the user is getting, support emotional imagination, remove date/math work and answer concerns about actual final cost and changes of plans.

Independent critique [I]: Large product imagery helps only when accurate, optimized and not crowding out task completion; the crossed-out reference price must be a real, valid comparison, not invented anchoring. The total must include all mandatory taxes/fees or be accurately qualified. ‘Free cancellation’ must match policy. A badge must be a verified designation. Creator’s assertion about relative booking performance cannot be upgraded to a causal claim.

MockMob application [I]: Exam-mode descriptions should preview a *real* experience and expected length, number of questions and scoring conventions. CTAs should indicate the action: ‘Start 45-minute Accountancy mock’ instead of ‘Explore’. Clearly expose prerequisites, payment, credit usage and whether a test can be paused/resumed.

Cross-case lessons [I]

1. Say what happens next: exact steps, duration, cost, cancellation, or state transitions, based on actual behavior.
2. Visual proof beats abstract decorations when users need to know what is being offered.
3. The true total is more helpful than an apparently small fragment of cost.
4. If uncertainty exists, name and contextualize it rather than pretending it is a fixed value.
5. Frame benefits in the user’s task language, not only commercial slogans.
6. Claims of ‘A/B winners’ should remain attributed until the actual trial methods and results are available.

Source separation

T: Timecodes above follow the retrieved public-caption transcript. **V:** No actual frames. **S:** The video’s indexed description and UX Peak creator website discuss the three example categories. **I:** Product adaptations, verification conditions, critique and testing recommendations. Marketing/sponsorship sections around 05:20–06:53 and 09:39–10:36 are not treated as independent evidence.

Research Paper D02 — The Shortest UX/UI Design Course

Creator: uxpeak | **YouTube:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=03Xw8UyC6uo | **Transcript:** https://youtube2text.diguardia.org/v/the-shortest-ux-ui-design-course-03Xw8UyC6uo | **Evidence:** T (caption-derived; 1,166 words and 183 segments per index), V unavailable. Extra discovered UX Peak video, not a direct user link.

What can be grounded in the retrieved caption segments [T]

- **00:00–01:10:** The creator distinguishes UX as the larger interaction journey and UI as the interface elements that deliver it: typography, spacing, color and icons. A good-looking screen and a usable flow are related but not identical.
- **01:10–01:43:** Figma is introduced as the canvas/tooling environment. The example exercise concerns a marketplace for digital products. Tool mechanics are not themselves evidence that a screen succeeds with users.
- **01:43–02:04:** A non-linear human-centered cycle (empathize, define, ideate, prototype and test) is named, with explicit ability to revisit earlier steps.
- **02:04 onward:** The creator’s paid course is promoted, so the learner should distinguish educational claims and sponsorship from demonstrated UX outcomes.

Generalization [I]

A model building UI should start by identifying the user, job-to-be-done, state, environmental constraints and the actual next action. Build a navigable wireframe/state machine before typography polish. Test critical flows, not just screenshots. Define page-level criteria for success and failure. If there’s no actual research, label assumptions and request validation; do not manufacture study quotes.

Specific application [I]

In MockMob, the question attempt, solution review, next-best-move recommendation, credit use and incomplete/expired exam must be described as connected journeys. A great score card is only good UX if students can interpret it, understand what caused it, and take a next step. In Circuit, permission gates and verification should be designed as stateful experiences, including loading, retry, denied and success.

Source hierarchy

T: caption transcript linked above. S: UX Peak’s official course outlines at https://www.uxpeak.com/pages/course. V: none. I: everything framed as an implementation rule or specific product recommendation. **No claim of exhaustively reproducing all 183 caption segments is made in this compact foundations paper.**

Research Note D03 — This UI/UX Redesign Will Teach You More Than 200 Tutorials Combined

Creator: uxpeak | **URL:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GGg61sdEjeI | **Indexed date:** 27 Aug 2026 | **Source found:** https://zolotube.com/watch?v=GGg61sdEjeI

Evidence status: S (published video-description mirror) ONLY. Not a transcript. No direct playback/frame access.

The indexed description says the video redesigns a mobile ecommerce product page from an inconsistent and busy experience toward a clearer purchase journey. It names information hierarchy, spacing, typography, color, product imagery, reviews, price, quantity selector, add-to-cart, sticky mobile CTA and multi-product scalability. Those are topics explicitly in the description; detailed actions or exact design values remain unknown without captions/video.

Research questions to resolve [I]

- Which element is the visual entry point before and after? Does it change based on device size?
- Which review signals are above the fold? Are ratings quantified and meaningful?
- How is current price separated from promotion / discount / shipping?
- Is quantity selection accessible by touch and keyboard? What happens at min/max inventory?
- Does a sticky purchase CTA obscure content or remain accessible while zooming?
- Is the same component system demonstrated across other product types?
- Does the creator support any claim of improved conversions with real experiments, or only visual reasoning?

Tentative implementation heuristic [I]

One coherent purchase experience must communicate identity, important features, price and next action, with trustworthy evidence and clear edge-state behavior. Do not automatically adopt sticky CTAs; test on small devices and with enlarged text. The questions above are **a research plan, not observed findings**.

Independent Research Memo — How to Detect and Prevent AI-Generated UI Slop

Important: User-prioritized original video https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XKDfs9xTzfw was **not retrievable** in this session. This is **not** a paper claiming to analyze that video. It is an independent supporting paper [S/I], staged so the future verified transcript/frames can be incorporated without conflation. This distinction is essential.

Independent sources [S]

- InterfaceKit (2026), *What is AI slop in UI design?* https://blog.interfacekit.io/what-is-ai-slop-ui-design — defines the problem as shipping generated output without product intent, validation, verification and review, rather than a particular color.
- Dardo Studio (2026), *Generic AI slop versus a deliberately designed website*: https://dardo.studio/en/blog/ai-slop-vs-designed-websites/ — emphasizes distinguishable audience, tasks, visual language and inspectable work.
- Clutch Marketing (2026), *Are Generic AI Websites the New 'AI Slop'?*: https://www.clutchmarketing.com/are-generic-ai-websites-the-new-ai-slop/ — illustrates why apparently finished visual polish can still fail customer-specific questions.
- Nielsen Norman Group, *Progressive Disclosure*: https://www.nngroup.com/articles/progressive-disclosure/ — useful counterweight to dashboard overpopulation; show frequent actions, defer rare advanced ones.
- W3C, WCAG 2.2: https://www.w3.org/TR/wcag/ — real accessibility standards, including predictable navigation and consistent identification.

Source quality note: The first three are practitioner essays, not independently randomized studies. Use as articulated approaches and critique, not numerical proof.

Working definition [I]

AI slop in UI/UX is output that resembles a plausible finished product but lacks sufficient evidence of deliberate product strategy, distinctive art direction, realistic content, complete flows and verified edge conditions. A gradient or glass card is not automatically bad; it is problematic when chosen automatically and repeated without reason. Conversely, a minimal black-and-white design can also be slop if it has no hierarchy, task logic or user-specific content.

Diagnostic matrix [I]

Dimension	Generic symptom	Deliberate alternative	Test
Information architecture	Identical 3-card summary everywhere	Structure matches the user’s next decision	Can user find target action without hunting?
Typography	Default same scale/ weight across contexts	Editorial hierarchy based on reading task	Are titles, numbers, labels distinguishable at a glance?
Brand	Logo/color swapped onto template	System reflects product context and audience	Hide logo; is the product still recognizable?
Copy	‘Unlock your potential’ / vague claims	Specific actions, verified facts and user vocabulary	Does copy answer a genuine user question?
Content	Placeholder stats, artificial testimonials	Authentic content with meaningful states	Are numbers and evidence sourced?
UI mechanics	Only happy-path polished	Loading, empty, error, partial and retry states	Can the product be used when something fails?
Motion	Unmotivated fades, decorative parallax	Motion communicates cause, continuity, feedback	What comprehension does the animation improve?
Navigation	Same sidebar whether mobile or consumer	Task-fit navigation with clear selected state	Is primary action reachable on small screens?
Trust	Fake badges, inconsistent pricing	Transparent terms, reliable data, accessible controls	Could a user misunderstand what they are consenting to?
Implementation	Pixel-perfect landing mock only	Working product and validated interactions	Are keyboard, screen readers and data behavior correct?

Source-inspired vs interpretation [S/I]

Source-inspired [S]: InterfaceKit emphasizes missing intent/ revision. Dardo argues for audience-specific choices and inspectable examples. Clutch emphasizes real-world needs and verified specificity. These remain their respective authors' framings.

Our synthesis [I]: Treat AI-generated UIs as hypotheses. The agent's job is not to 'add a premium feel' by inserting gradients, dense badges or glow; it is to make a series of falsifiable decisions about the task, hierarchy, copy, responsive behavior and edge states. Build, inspect, critique, revise and test.

12-part anti-slop acceptance test [I]

1. **Product identity:** Does the screen convey a specific product even with the logo obscured? Specify distinguishing constraints, not just adjectives.
2. **One primary action:** Is the next useful user action visually and verbally clear? Exceptions should be explicitly justified.
3. **True content:** Are metrics real, placeholders labeled, dates valid and testimonials sourced?
4. **Hierarchy:** Can users identify the most relevant content in under a short first scan? Test with real users; do not assert a fixed universal duration.
5. **Composition:** Do margins, alignment and text measure follow intentional responsive rules rather than arbitrary grids?
6. **Meaningful typography:** Are typography styles defined by roles (display, title, body, label, data) and readable under zoom?
7. **Statefulness:** Are loading, error, retry, empty, partial, disabled, and success states present?
8. **Accessible interaction:** Keyboard focus, minimum sensible target size, semantics, contrast and reduced motion support.
9. **No pseudo-evidence:** No invented usage counts, progress, urgency, reviews, conversion uplifts, real-time availability or endorsements.
10. **Motion rationale:** Each transition explains state or orientation; reduce motion when requested.
11. **Measured usability:** Agree on one leading product metric and one guardrail (e.g., activation + wrong-choice corrections).

12. **Human critique:** Ask ‘What would be better without this?’ for every decorative block; remove components without a task purpose.

Example: a CUET study product, without generic SaaS tropes [I]

Weak: Welcome, four glowing KPI cards, generic charts, an unearned ‘AI-powered’ label, and five equal CTA tiles.

Purposeful: One current exam state, a clear last-result diagnosis, a single next-best-move recommendation grounded in actual attempt history, why it was suggested, and a direct entry to the recommended practice. Prioritize the student’s subject and evidence confidence. Do not generate a personalized recommendation when the history is too sparse; use ‘take a baseline mock’ as the honest next step instead.

Example: campus social app [I]

Weak: Pinterest-like mosaic of events, communities and marketplace widgets with every block competing equally.

Purposeful: Current campus / verified identity clearly established; one Today feed for timely campus actions; Discover for broader exploration; explicit privacy for anonymous/community posts; fast empty states and real events. Platform navigation should match user tasks and device conventions.

Evaluation rubric [I]

Each dimension score 0/1/2 (missing / partially implemented / validated): task fit, information architecture, content truth, readable hierarchy, visual specificity, accessibility, functional states, trust, intentional motion, performance, responsive integrity and instrumentation. **Do not equate the resulting score with research-backed product quality**; it is an internal review checklist. Require a human designer/product owner to sign off before launch.

What’s needed to complete the requested XKDfs9xTzfw paper [pending T/V]

A verifiable title and author, actual caption transcript (or audio), chapter timestamps, speaker claims, example-app names, and at least two pairs of direct frames (generic vs differentiated) with provenance. Then build a separate video-specific paper referencing this independent memo where helpful. **Do not label the independent memo as a summary of XKDfs9xTzfw.**

Channel Context — Tim Gabe (not a video transcript)

Requested channel: https://www.youtube.com/@TimGabe

YouTube channel video inventory: not retrieved in full. **YouTube transcripts:** none reliably retrieved in this research session. **Video frames:** none. Consequently **NO Tim Gabe video has been analyzed as though watched.**

Verified supporting source [S]

The creator’s website https://timgabe.com/ presents *The Fullstack Creative*, describes his creative design practice, and directs readers to resources. His Framer course https://timgabe.com/framer-course is explicitly positioned around making custom web designs; https://timgabe.com/old/old-home lists design exercises such as scroll effects, parallax, sticky-scroll interactions, button animations and nested tabs.

These are **website/marketing descriptions**, not claims from a specific YouTube video. The website is enough to identify a potential research theme — implementing distinctive and purposeful web experiences — but not enough to assert the creator’s exact recommendations or motion specifications in any video.

Research agenda [I]

- Compare actual implementation demos against eventual deployed Framer experiences and identify where visual craft serves navigation, product clarity or storytelling.
- Record how motion communicates hierarchy, progress, context and spatial continuity, versus effects that merely decorate.
- For any animation demos, capture before/intermediate/after frames and note trigger, duration and easing only where shown or measurable.
- Test responsive and accessibility behavior, especially reduced-motion support, keyboard focus, overflow and scroll-linked effects.

- Build a portable set of code-agnostic motion rules, and distinguish Framer-specific mechanics from generally applicable UX principles.

Product adaptation [I]

For MockMob or Circuit, motion should help users understand state changes, not make exam-taking or campus navigation slower. A result card transition or onboarding step can benefit from clear visual continuity; continuously animated hero graphics and heavy scroll effects are rarely appropriate in a timed exam environment.

Status: contextual source map; a per-video paper cannot responsibly be produced until the video’s identity and source content are retrieved.

AI Design Agent Rules — Evidence-Qualified

These are our independent, product-oriented **recommendations [I]**, informed by the linked papers; they are **not direct orders from the video creators**. If an implementation rule conflicts with product requirements, actual data, WCAG, privacy, or law, the stricter real requirement wins.

Source use / no hallucination (P0)

1. Before designing, identify the intended user, user task, actual data, current screen state and success criterion.
2. Match design suggestions to the relevant video paper. Cite evidence IDs (e.g., T003) in design notes rather than attributing them vaguely to ‘best practices’.
3. Never say a creator recommended an option unless the timestamped transcript explicitly supports it. Never call a marketing video description an actual transcript.
4. Never say a sample screenshot is from a video unless it was extracted from the actual video with a verifiable timestamp.
5. Never invent usability-test results, A/B-test winners, conversion percentages, Figma files, brand approvals, pricing discounts, testimonials, or real usage metrics.
6. Treat a narrator’s behavioral-science number as a **claim**, not independently established evidence. Independent evaluation is required before citing it as science.

Information architecture / hierarchy (P0)

1. Choose ONE clear main action for a task-oriented screen; multiple equal calls to action need a documented reason.
2. Rank content by what helps the user decide next, not by back-end entity or ease of development.
3. Make essential data scan-friendly: value before label where appropriate, clear units, meaningful status and dates.

4. Progressive disclosure is appropriate for *secondary* functions; do not hide frequent/important controls just to look minimalist (S014).
5. Preserve navigation consistency, accessible labels and selected state (S016).
6. Prefer simple vertical content rhythm for dense consumer mobile screens; use a grid only when simultaneous comparison is useful.

Onboarding / forms (P0)

1. Use visible editable defaults only when backed by real context or reasonable safe assumptions (T001, S015).
2. Never preselect consent, paid upgrades, data sharing or privacy-sensitive opt-ins just to increase conversion.
3. Let users experience some meaningful product value before an account wall when privacy and abuse prevention allow (T003).
4. Persist user-entered work through authentication wherever possible; do not engineer artificial sunk-cost pressure (T004).
5. Make progress truthful; never count steps a person has not completed (T002, S015).
6. Clarify what happens next (count, time, task) when accurate; use generic language when dynamic facts are unknown.

Trust / commercial patterns (P0)

1. Present real fees and renewal terms clearly; never compare monthly and one-time amounts as if equivalent (T006).
2. If offering trials, state end date/period, reminder arrangements (only if real), price and cancellation path (T007).
3. Avoid invented crossed-out prices, discount badges, availability or urgency (T009).
4. Do not implement shame-based dismissal, fabricated countdown, coercive loss prompts or false data deletion (T005).
5. If a price is variable, say ‘estimate/range’ rather than presenting an unbacked fixed quote (T008).
6. Any claims of ‘AI mentor’ and ‘personalization’ must correspond to actually functioning system logic and known limits.

Premium execution / visual systems (P1)

1. Start from content hierarchy and task logic, then specify typography roles, spacing scale and surfaces.
2. Use distinct product art direction; refuse generic gradient/glass/dashboard defaults unless the design brief actually requires them.
3. Prioritize actual screen or product preview over unrelated illustrations when proving utility (T007, T009).
4. Apply whitespace to separate concepts, not arbitrarily enlarge everything.
5. Use numerals with units and understandable comparison context; dates need locale and actual timezone when relevant.
6. Define component variants, density behavior, selected state, hover/focus, touch targets, loading and error states.
7. Motion needs a purpose (state change, continuity, feedback), with reduced-motion behavior and no essential information conveyed solely by animation.
8. Keep the essential action available on mobile but confirm a sticky CTA does not conceal content, keyboard, or assistive UI.
9. Cards should group meaningful items; do not create cards for every label purely to fill space.

Implementation and evaluation (P0)

1. Verify working behavior against the design on actual small and large viewports.
2. Test empty, error, timeout, retry, partial, no-data and permission-denied states.
3. Test keyboard-only behavior, screen reader semantics, focus order, visible focus, text zoom, contrast and reduced motion; use WCAG 2.2 as baseline (S016).
4. Define test metrics **and guardrails** before choosing an allegedly high-conversion pattern.
5. Never mark a UX hypothesis as proven because an agent/creator says it ‘feels premium’.
6. Include an explicit `DESIGN_DECISIONS.md` in a feature PR with user task, screen alternatives, reason, evidence IDs, tradeoffs, unresolved assumptions, screenshot comparisons and verification notes.

7. Run an anti-slop rubric review; do not ship solely based on pixel polish.

Product-specific overlays [I]

MockMob

- Every recommendation (‘next best move’) should explain the supporting history, confidence, and actionable subject/problem; if insufficient data, state that clearly and suggest the first diagnostic action.
- Give a free/guest test a truthful small experience before signup, where feasible; map guest progress to login.
- During exams, avoid distracting upsells; protect timer, answer persistence, network reconnection and submitted-state clarity.
- Explain AI uncertainty and credit/quota costs before irreversible model calls.
- Use real exam results rather than fake score dashboards to impress prospects.

Circuit

- Separate Today (urgent/relevant), Discover (broader), People, Listings, Communities, Inbox and Profile by task and state; do not surface them as a noisy equal-weight mosaic.
- Verified identity and anonymous content require especially transparent permission and privacy affordances.
- Show campus-specific information and real event data; a polished empty state is better than fake activity.
- Favor list scanning on mobile, distinguish immediate action from exploration and expose location/time with clear context.

PR review questions

1. What user decision does the page help with?
2. What do you remove without reducing useful information?
3. What does the primary action do *exactly*?
4. Which specific evidence IDs or user observations justify non-obvious choices?
5. What could mislead users here (progress, price, data, personalization, urgency)?

6. How does the screen behave in loading/error/no-data/ permission/slow-device states?
7. How will we know whether the design is better rather than merely different?

Research Protocol — Transcript, Visual Capture, Source QA

Capture goals

Create **one independently reviewable paper per video**, especially all UX Peak uploads. Do not combine multiple uploads into one generic channel opinion. Link supplementary cross-video synthesis to original per-video evidence IDs.

Repeatable ingestion stages

1. Export the entire `@uxpeak/videos` and `@TimGabe/videos` public inventories, including ID, exact title, date, duration and URL. Record retrieval timestamp and pagination completeness. Mark deleted/private/region-blocked material separately. Reconcile against the five direct links; never substitute videos by topic.
2. Obtain YouTube-sourced captions (language, manual/ASR, provenance, timestamps). Store the original source outside this research package when the publisher/rights permit, while research package maintains short quotations and extensive analytical paraphrase. Identify uncertain words and automatic-caption failures.
3. Segment into 30–120-second units; code creator claim, example, UI before/after, rationale, numeric assertion, sponsor/promotion, and uncertainty separately.
4. Review accessible video itself and capture stable true frames at decisive changes. For animation/motion, sample start, midpoint, end, interaction trigger and reduced-motion alternative if shown.
5. For each claim identify whether it is (a) narrated hypothetical, (b) creator’s anecdotal experience, (c) shown real app UI, or (d) reproducible study. Never upgrade category without evidence.
6. Cross-check statistics or named studies against original accessible sources. Mark uncorroborated numbers ‘creator claim — unverified’.
7. Write video paper with four mandatory layers: T (transcript), V (verified footage), S (external source), I (independent analysis); include competing interpretations and limitation.

8. Validate operational recommendations with UX research, WCAG, actual business logic, instrumentation and on-device testing.

Screenshot standard

For each figure supply: - `video_id`, canonical URL, media-access method and media-file checksum. - Timestamp (seconds), original frame dimensions, resize/crop specifications. - Caption distinguishing **what was visibly in the video** from **what the creator said** and **what the analyst infers**. - Before/after pairing if relevant; do not infer unobserved interactions from two stills. - If screenshot contains non-source graphics, annotate and separate into ‘analyst illustration’, not original footage. - Permission and copyright compliance; use limited frames for analytical illustration with attribution and avoid distributing large video excerpts.

Video review template

```
source_id: R04
video_id: 2TlIg3VokY8
creator: uxpeak
coverage: full_verified_caption | sampled_video | full_video_reviewed
T: timecoded spoken paraphrase + minimal exact quotes
V: verified screenshot pairs and described visible states
S: creator's own claims, product links, scientific/UX sources
I: rationale, competing hypotheses, adoption decision, test plan
claim_status: observed | creator_asserted | external_supported | unverified
recommended_action: adopt | adapt | experiment | reject | insufficient_evidence
```

Important limitations in this edition

Direct retrieval of YouTube playback/channel inventories was throttled. Only one of the original five video links had a verified timestamped transcript in indexed third-party sources. Three more UX Peak video assets were discovered; two have transcript access and one has description access. There are NO source video screenshots in this edition. This is a clearly labeled interim research package, not a claim that the whole channel was viewed.

How to unblock the full requested research

Provide original MP4 files or footage exports for every desired video (or a legal, usable channel/video archive), with SRT/VTT caption exports or speech audio when possible. For comprehensive `@uxpeak/videos` coverage, an exported video URL inventory helps ensure

none are missed. An MP4 with its caption track is best because we can distinguish all three critical layers: the creator’s words, the actual screen state and external concept analysis.